

Whangarei District Council Meeting Minutes

Date: Tuesday, 16 May, 2023
Time: 9:00 a.m.
Location: Council Chamber
Forum North, Rust Avenue
Whangarei

In Attendance

His Worship the Mayor Vince Cocurullo
Cr Gavin Benney
Cr Nicholas Connop
Cr Ken Couper
Cr Phil Halse
Cr Deborah Harding
Cr Patrick Holmes
Cr Scott McKenzie
Cr Marie Olsen
Cr Carol Peters
Cr Simon Reid
Cr Phoenix Ruka
Cr Paul Yovich (Teams)

Not in Attendance

Cr Jayne Golightly

Scribe

N. Pestana (Team Leader Democracy)

Administrative matters

- Copies of all submissions provided to Councillors.
- Late submissions in Volumes 10 and 11 tabled at the meeting.
- Meeting livestreamed.
- Hearing procedure outlined.

1. Karakia/Prayer

Cr Ruka opened the meeting with a karakia.

2. Declarations of Interest / Take Whaipānga

There were no declarations of interest made.

3. **Apologies / Kore Tae Mai**

Cr Golightly (absent), Cr Yovich (late arrival and early departure).

Moved By Cr Gavin Benney

Seconded By Cr Deborah Harding

That the apologies be sustained.

Carried

4. **Decision Reports / Whakatau Rīpoata**

4.1 **Annual Plan 2023-24 Hearings and Submissions, 2023-24 Fees and Charges**

Moved By Cr Nicholas Connop

Seconded By Cr Patrick Holmes

That the Council:

1. Receive and hear the submissions relating to the Consultation Document for the 2023-24 Annual Plan.
2. Receive and hear the submissions relating to the Statement of Proposal for 2023-24 Fees and Charges.
3. That any submissions identified as being received after the close of the submissions period (prior to the closure of this meeting) be accepted for consideration by Council).

Carried

Submitters who were heard are listed:

Brent Hill – Option 2.

Colin Blackman – Objection to any proposed rate increase.

Robin Lieffering – Option 1 and prioritise maintenance and repair of roads in district, all new seal programmes transferred to road maintenance budget. No new seals 2024. Postpone city-centre improvements, new fields at Ruakaka and Tikipunga, no to Oruku Landing (tabled speaking notes)

Kim Robinson - Option 1. Better footpaths.

Christopher Taplin - Option 2. No to Three Waters, Ministry of Works and Infrastructure in New Zealand to model-fund and assist in carrying out major capital works.

Judy Plain – Cat desexing and microchipping campaigns, cat education and Bylaw Compliance Officer.

Mia Boots – Oppose Option 1 (tabled speaking notes)

Deborah Seerup - Object to any rates increase. Resource consents process (tabled documents)

Mark Rasmussen – Option 2 (tabled document).

Reesa Styles - Object to any rates increase.

Pamela Hodgson – Option 2.

David Colley- Object to any rates increase.

Crichton Christie – Option 2.

John Clark – Option 2.

Cornelia Pike - Objection to any proposed rate increase.

Alan Palmer – Option 1. Walkway / cycleway along Whangarei Heads Road, theatre for Whangarei.

Frank Newman – Democracy Northland – Oppose Option 1. Engagement process, review of expenditure.

Frank Newman - Oppose Option 1. Review of expenditure.

Nora Shayeb – Northland Toxin Awareness Group (tabled document)

Nora Shayeb - Objection to any proposed rate increase. Enhancing local democracy, town and urban planning, Environmental Engineering Standards.

Pamela Hodgson – Friends of Gomez - Object to any rates increase. Reallocation of funding, no dirt bike trail on Gomez Road.

Brian Calder - Oppose Option 1.

Alison Thompson - Objection to any proposed rate increase.

Scott Fratcher - Objection to any proposed rate increase.

Nancy Mirales - Oppose Option 1.

Colin Hannah – Federated Farmers – Support Option 2. Support prioritise first 2.5% of rate increase to roading, focus on flood protection and drain clearing in rural areas, review unnecessary expenditure, increase UAGC to make rates allocation within the rural sector more equitable.

Alan Agnew – 2% increase in rates with reduction on spending. Airport change, Helicopter base, Indoor bowls, Daylight savings (tabled documents)

James Griffin – Parua Bay Residents and Ratepayers – Support Option 1 with corresponding increase in quality of service.

Cherry Hermon – Forum North Trust 2014 – Lachie Mclean spoke to submission. Option 1. New theatre for Whangarei.

Margaret Coote – Object to Option 1.

James Percy – Ngunguru Skatepark Committee – Kate Percy spoke to submission. Funding for completion of design work at Ngunguru Skatepark in the 2023 Annual Plan.

Christine Woods – support neither option 1 or option 2. Spraying of toxins on roadsides.

Alexandra Resch – Object to any rates increase.

David Baynes – Object to rates increase (tabled speaking notes)

Angela Stolwerk – Waipu Cycle and Walkway Trust – Option 1. Development of walkways and cycleways.

Stu Middleton, Craig Carter – Sport Northland / Aquatic Centre – Budget adjustment to operational budget of the Whangarei Aquatic Centre, support 12.5% to 25% price increase for casual admission entry prices to Whangarei Aquatic Centre.

Janet Atkinson – Object to option 1. Remove WDC from LGNZ.

Alison Jeffs – 5% rates increase. Remove WDC from LGNZ, prevent Three Waters.

Patrick Tattley – Option 2.

Alexandra Badham (Hart) – Businesses at Town Basin impacted by various challenges and Town Basin Car Parking closure.

Linda Matson – Linda Gardner spoke to submission. Objection to any proposed rate increase.

A break was taken from 9.30am to 9.45am following the submission of Christopher Taplin.

Cr Yovich joined the meeting on Teams on 9.45am after the break.

A tea break was taken from 11.37am to 11.50am following the submission of Brian Calder.

Cr Yovich did not rejoin the meeting after the tea break.

A lunch break was taken from 12.02pm to 1.15pm following the submission of Scott Fratcher.

Cr Ruka closed the meeting with a karakia.

6. Closure of Meeting / Te katinga o te Hui

The meeting concluded at 3.04pm.

Confirmed this 25th day of May 2023.

His Worship the Mayor Vince Cocurullo (Chairperson)